Contact

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Top Skills

Product Development
Solidworks
Manufacturing

Patents

Direct mount optic system for pistols
Multi-configuration grappling hook system
Case for portable electronic device
Case for electronic device
Case for portable electronic communications device

Eric Hostetler

Propulsion at Scale
Silverado, California, United States

Summary

I have a very broad experience base that involves both domestic and off shore manufacturing, at both small companies and large. This provides me with a unique perspective that helps me develop process and organizations that are tailored for the size and goals of the task at hand. After many years of working on consumer goods, I have found my true passion in the defense space over the last 6 years.

Experience

Volund Manufacturing
CEO | Founder
January 2025 - Present (1 year 6 months)
Orange County, California, United States

Echo Arms
Owner
January 2015 - Present (11 years 6 months)
Orange County, California, United States

• Echo Arms produces a line of consumer facing products geared towards the high-end tactical gun owner, particularly those who owned night vision devices. The product line includes machined aluminum and steel parts, clothing and stickers, injection molded parts and more. All parts of the product creation process happen under our roof including design, manufacturing, and packaging. All metallic parts are machined and marked in house.
• Echo Arms also provides product design, development and manufacturing services to the high-end tactical gun market. Since 2015, we have been providing design engineering and light industrial design to brands like Noveske Rifleworks, Meridian Defense, Tri-arc Systems, Sons of Liberty Gun Works, BE Meyers and more. We work with the companies to provide on-brand, market relevant designs ready for manufacturing. We provide serialized 3d printed receivers for form and fit verification before heading to metal prototypes. Fully complete GD&T prints are provided for documentation, manufacturing and quality control purposes. As this grew, it became clear there was an

opportunity to take the parts designed and manufacture for my clients as well. Since 2020, many of the designs I provided to clients also went to production under my roof.

Anduril Industries

Deployment Operations Materials Manager

May 2019 - December 2022 (3 years 8 months)

Irvine, CA

•Established process for deployment planning. Prior to my role, the customer facing teams rarely had a good process for communicating each deployments' needs with the teams that designed, manufactured and prepared hardware. I began by identifying the information necessary to completing an equipment deployment successfully. I worked this into a presentation template that the deployment owners used to kick off the event to all teams. The information from these kickoffs was then distilled into a series of interconnected Jira projects that allowed a high level dashboard tracking of all deployments, who had how much work to do, and overall status of each deployment. The final piece of the puzzle was creating a transition from Jira tickets to ERP system to build, buy, allocate, pull and ship all relevant hardware to each deployment. A documented process with defined phase gates and deliverables was iterated and implemented leading to a near 100% successful deployment process.
•One of the larger stumbling blocks to scaling our deployment process ended up being the items that Anduril did not design and manufacture. I drew upon my technical experience and design engineering experience to source and spec out COTS product solutions for these items. This included a broad spectrum of items from McMaster-Carr parts to 5 figure military mesh radios. Because these were "simple" items, the organization frequently overlooked them or neglected them outright. This led to delays, frustrations and added expense for nearly every deployment. All items were brought into the same process to allow downstream teams to use the same process, part numbers, PLM and ERP systems to manage all items in a consistent efficient manner. Eventually this led to nearly 50% of the items needed to successfully install an Anduril system being items I put into our system.

Apple

Engineering Program Manager

October 2015 - May 2019 (3 years 8 months)

Culver City, California

• Engineering Program Managers at Apple are responsible for taking a project from the ideation phase through mass production and ensuring

that all objectives are met for over a dozen teams. We work with product management, industrial design, advanced materials, quality, RF, safety, environmental, costing and variety of other teams on up to a dozen projects at a time. Budgets on a single project approach a half million dollars without tooling costs.

• The line extensions team works within the Beat by Dre organization to help develop and commercialize innovative new paint, ink, coating and decoration techniques on an accelerated schedule to produce the proucts that Beats by Dre uses in over 90% of its marketing impressions worldwide.

Incase

Development Manager Hardhoods

March 2014 - September 2015 (1 year 7 months)

Chino, California

• Development Manager for all injection molded product at Incase. Responsible for creating and producing tooling ready injection files for vendors in both the US and China. Responsible for ensuring tooling was completed to specification according to schedule and beginning production on time.

• Responsible for hiring and training new 3D CAD engineers and product development personnel.

• Owned costing and negotiations for both tooling and per unit prices. Drove a nearly 50% reduction in FOB Pricing through the implementation of creative tooling methods to use in mold texturing instead of costly and polluting coatings.

• Developed product development budgets as well as employee compensation, travel, and overhead budgets.

• Inventor of 4 patent pending designs including 2 electronics cases utilizing new impact absorbing characteristics as well as a test methodology to determine electronics case performance in a laboratory environment and testing methodologies.

Fox Head, Inc.

Performance Product Development Manager

November 2010 - March 2014 (3 years 5 months)

Irvine, CA

• Development Manager for Fox Racing hard goods, including MX helmets and guards, IVI Vision, Fox eyewear and MX goggles.

• Hired to develop a whole new eyewear development program and team specific to the Fox brand and company. Fox wishes to move its currently outsourced eyewear in house and decrease lead times. Sourced and

established new factory relationships for price point Fox eyewear, Fox MX goggles and high end IVI Eyewear. Lead development for whole product lines to backfill the line that was previously outsourced.

• Hired to improve the development process and improve the 3D capabilities of the industrial design team. Sourced and implemented a 3D modeling and rapid prototyping program to improve the product development process and increase design iterations to allow for more finely tuned designs.

• Created and implemented key date tracking and proper phase gate design reviews to identify and solve problems processes and methodology.

Oakley Inc.

Eyewear Development Engineer

August 2005 - October 2010 (5 years 3 months)

*Development Engineer for all Oakley wire and acetate frames as well as several injection molded frames made overseas. Design engineers oversee the entire product from cradle to grave. We start with design sketches and maintain all aspects of the product through its discontinuation. Balanced the needs of the design team, quality team and manufacturing team to deliver a consistently high performance piece of art. Communicated with vendors in China, Taiwan, Hong Kong and Japan. Organized the complicated process of making semi-finished goods in Asia and then final manufacturing and assembly in the Oakley Foothill Ranch facility. This position involved working with a variety of individuals, including vendors, industrial designers, purchasing, sourcing, quality control, internal manufacturing and domestic and international sales teams.

*Development Engineer for all Fox eyewear products including wire and acetate frames made overseas as well as domestic injection molded products.

Haro Bicycle Corp.

Product Manager/Engineer

November 2003 - February 2005 (1 year 4 months)

*Product manager and designer for all aftermarket parts and accessories for Haro bicycles, Masi Road bikes, and Premium Products. This position involved working with a variety of individuals, including team riders, vendors, designers, marketing and sales. Responsible for designing, developing, sourcing, and costing new projects. This also includes writing catalog copy and developing the catalog layout.

*Key designer and developer for all of Haro’s protective apparel, gloves, racing pants and jerseys. Some of the protective equipment incorporated innovative new materials.

*This position also incorporated a marketing role in coordinating products tests, spotlights, and product text to all major bicycle publications. Other marketing duties involved writing text for the Premium Products and Haro Bikes web pages.
*Coordinated all sales promotions for parts and accessories.

Vans Inc.
Project Developer/Engineer
June 2002 - November 2003 (1 year 6 months)

*Project developer for all of Pro-Tec's new 2004 products. These projects included a new alpine ski helmet, a new high-end snowboard helmet, new skate helmet and a new Freeride MTB helmet. Other projects also included updating four existing helmet models as well as developing new protective equipment. This role had a variety of responsibilities including materials selection, small parts design, prototyping, developing CAD models, laboratory testing, creating finished engineering drawings and bills of materials. CAD models were reverse engineered from 3D models using a Microscribe CMM to produce surface models. These surface models were then modified to fit design and safety criteria and then sent out for rapid tooling prototypes.
*Partnered with product development director to implement a new development cycle that saved time and money through implementing modern rapid prototyping that improved product quality by allowing more design iterations.

Education

University of California, Los Angeles
B.S.Mechanical Engineering · (1998 - 2002)